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<div align="center"> <!-- Animated Banner -->  <!-- Badges --> <p>       </p> <p> <a href="#-demo">View Demo</a> • <a href="#-
features">Features</a> • <a href="#-tech-stack">Tech Stack</a> • <a href="#-system-
flow">System Flow</a> • <a href="#-installation">Installation</a> • <a href="#-
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About The Project

Lost & Found is a full-stack web application that bridges the gap between people who have lost items and those who have found them — creating a trusted community-driven platform for item recovery.

Whether it's a wallet left on a bus, keys dropped at a park, or a phone forgotten at a café — **Lost & Found** makes it effortless to post, search, and reconnect lost items with their rightful owners through smart matching, real-time notifications, and secure communication.

Features

Feature	Description
 Post Lost / Found Items	Easily report lost or found items with photos, location, and description
 Smart Search & Filter	Search by category, date, location, and keywords
 Location Mapping	Visual map view to spot items near you using Leaflet/Google Maps
 Real-Time Notifications	Instant alerts when a matching item is posted
 Secure Messaging	In-app chat between finders and owners — no personal info shared
 Auth & Profiles	JWT-based authentication with user dashboards
 Claim Verification	Multi-step ownership verification before handoff
 Admin Dashboard	Manage reports, users, and flagged items

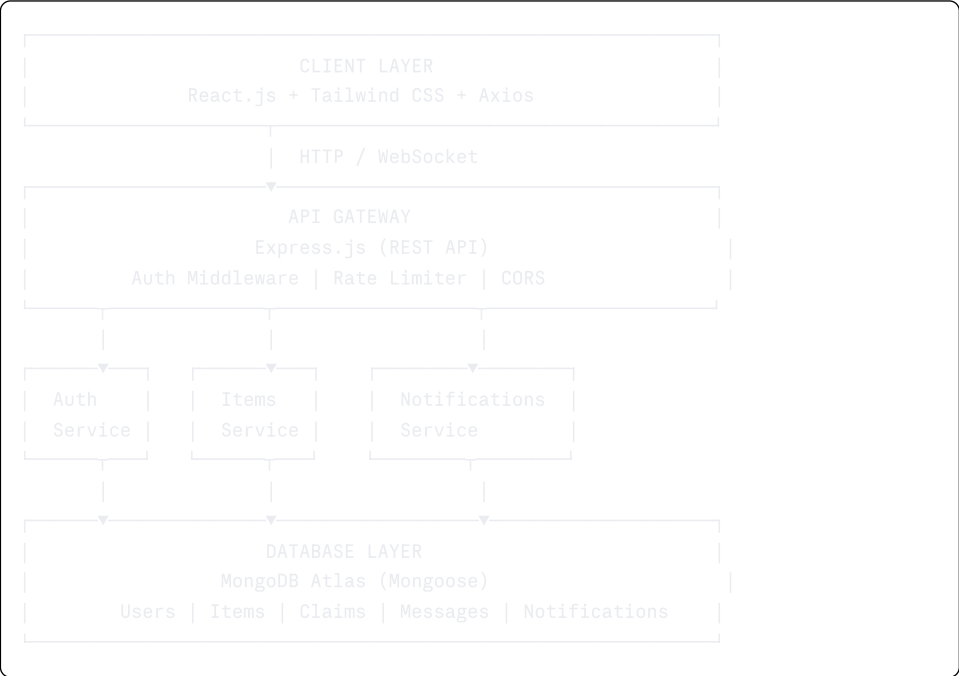
Tech Stack

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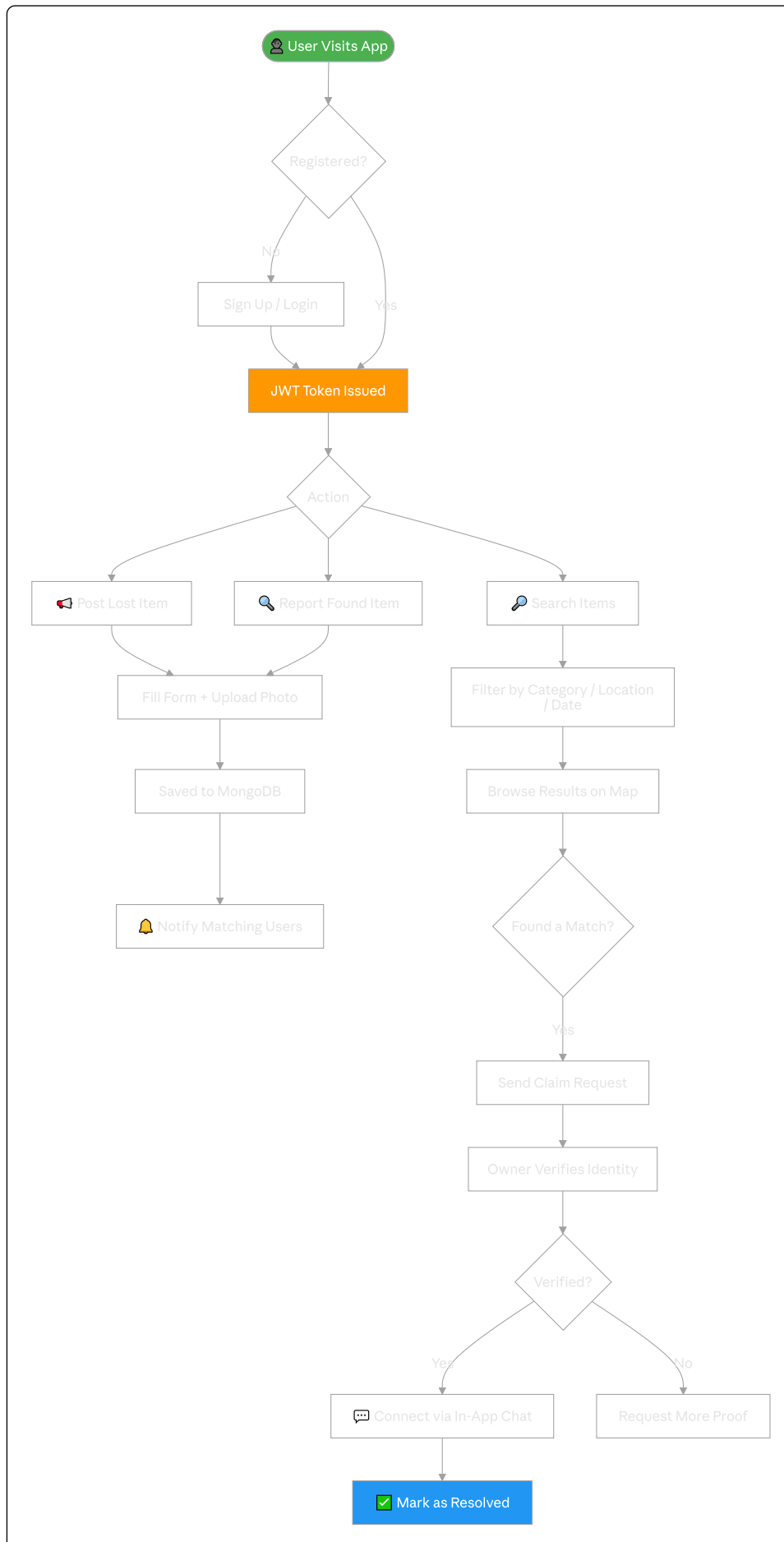
Layer	Technology
Frontend	React.js · Tailwind CSS · Axios
Backend	Node.js · Express.js
Database	MongoDB (Mongoose ODM)
Authentication	JWT · bcrypt
Real-time	Socket.io
Storage	Cloudinary (image uploads)
Maps	Leaflet.js / Google Maps API
Deployment	Vercel (Frontend) · Render (Backend)

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 System Architecture



Application Flow

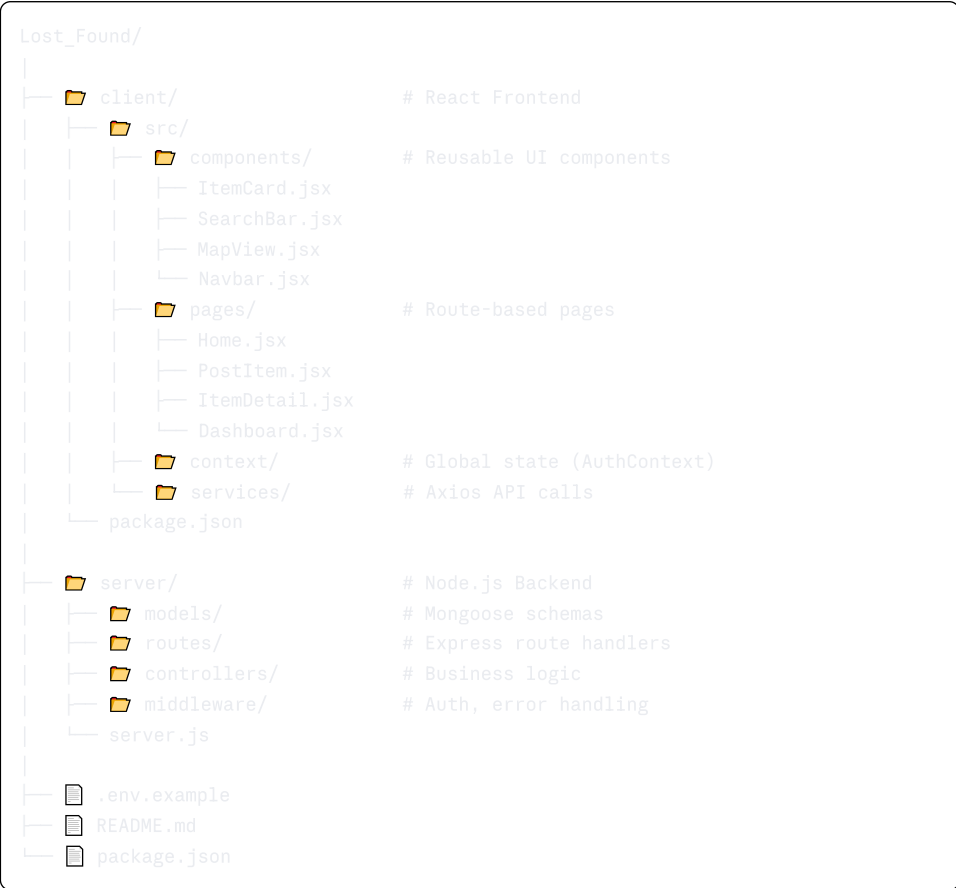


Database Schema





📁 **Project Structure**



🚀 **Installation & Setup**

Prerequisites

- Node.js v18+
- MongoDB (local or Atlas URI)
- npm or yarn

Clone the Repository

```
bash
git clone https://github.com/YOUR_USERNAME/Lost_Found.git
cd Lost_Found
```

Backend Setup

```
bash
cd server
npm install

# Create .env file
cp .env.example .env
# Fill in: MONGO_URI, JWT_SECRET, CLOUDINARY_KEY, etc.

npm run dev
```

Frontend Setup

```
bash
cd client
npm install
npm start
```

The app will run at `http://localhost:3000` with the API at `http://localhost:5000`

🔑 API Endpoints

Method	Endpoint	Description	Auth
POST	/api/auth/register	Register new user	✗
POST	/api/auth/login	Login & get JWT	✗
GET	/api/items	Get all items	✗
POST	/api/items	Post a lost/found item	✓
GET	/api/items/:id	Get single item	✗
PUT	/api/items/:id	Update item	✓
DELETE	/api/items/:id	Delete item	✓
POST	/api/claims/:itemId	Submit a claim	✓
GET	/api/messages/:userId	Get messages	✓

📊 Project Stats

 Total Commits:

50+

 Components:

15+

 API Routes:

20+

 DB Collections:

5

 Build Time:

~2 mins

 Responsive:

✓ Mobile Friendly

💖 Contributing

Contributions are what make open source amazing! Here's how:

```
bash

# 1. Fork the repository
# 2. Create your feature branch
git checkout -b feature/AmazingFeature

# 3. Commit your changes
git commit -m "Add some AmazingFeature"

# 4. Push to the branch
git push origin feature/AmazingFeature

# 5. Open a Pull Request
```

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Author

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Your Name

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Made with ❤️ by [Your Name]

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